



DVD player baffles rocket scientists

The astronauts in the space shuttle Atlantis mission to fix the Hubble telescope, couldn't get a DVD player to work. The problem was that they didn't have any software installed, and Houston couldn't beam one up to them.

Big market

The estimated DVD player market in India is estimated to be around 50 Lakhs per annum by market leaders

DVD Player Test

with resolutions such as 1366 x 768, as the pixelation reduced when we used that.

Mitashi also sent us the PH 2000 2.1 speaker system that will give you better sound quality than your TV. But when we tested the quality we found that at some points the highs were overpowering the midrange and also the lows were not impactful or powerful enough.



Mitashi PH-4050

Mitashi DHD 911: The cops are not coming after this one

When we did our last DVD player test, this model turned out to be the victor, but we really wanted to see how well it will stand up to the new contenders. The physical appearance is the same as the Intex R-145, with only a different colour scheme. Now which brand has copied which is something we can't really say, but it sure does look like there has been some copying here. The body of this player is silver-grey in colour whereas the front panel is black, similar to the R-145. Mitashi has stuck with the blue light display emitting of the CD tray with this DVD player as well.

The design and layout of the buttons on this player are identical to that of the Intex R-145. Even the quality of these buttons is the same, where you have to apply more force to these hard buttons.

HOW WE TESTED

Physical Appearance: Aesthetics was a big plus

Connectivity: Being able to connect your TV to your player and sound system easily is what we were looking for. Composite, Component, 5.1-channel audio ports and HDMI ports were the most looked for. Having HDMI connectivity is great as it eliminates the use of RCA and composite cables or component connectivity as both audio and video are passed through one cable. S-Video port, VGA port and DVI port is an addition for those who wish to connect their PCs to their DVD player. All the DVD players we tested came with USB ports and most of

them also came with memory card support. This is a big advantage as you can watch movies straight off your pen drive or memory card.

VCD quality: Even though once you own a DVD player you wouldn't want to look back and purchasing movies on VCDs, but for those with an existing VCD collection, you can also play your VCDs on DVD players. We observed scenes from the movie *Reindeer Games* in which, there are scenes where different shades of green are distinguished, and the other colours are also visible.

DVD quality: We used two movies for this part of the test — *Good Will Hunting* and

Crash. In *Good Will Hunting* we observed the colours of city life in general and in *Crash* the main explosion was noted for all the DVD players.

Audio quality: We tested 320 kbps MP3 tracks to see the difference in the highs, mids and lows to see if different players would reproduce these tracks differently.

Additional features: The more features the better we always say. But there are some things a DVD player needs to have, like easy navigation through its menus, a good USB interface for those with USB ports and other features such as karaoke is also a bonus.

The remote control provided with this player differed from the Mitashi DVB 317 but had really tiny round buttons on them and was not good to use. The layout of the menu system of this player was not good at all, the colour scheme selected was just not working correctly and did not look pleasant to the eye. Navigating through the USB menu was a real bad experience as the files were all over the place and were not categorised in the folders they were put in.

Mitashi also sent us the PH 4050 5.1 home theatre speaker system along with this player.

The satellites of the speaker were small and shaped like squares, while the subwoofer was slim. The subwoofer had its own LED display and remote control from where you could adjust the bass and overall volume.

While listening to our test tracks we found the bass too loose and the mids were not that pronounced.



Mitashi DHD 911

While watching videos we observed that different shades of green were getting blended together and like the Mitashi DVB 317 there was clear pixelation when we were viewing some high resolution images. Similarly, when we saw the same photos in a wide screen resolution such as 1366 x 768, the pixelation was greatly reduced.

The only additional feature going for the DHD

911 is the provision of an HDMI port and a card reader slot which is absent in the Mitashi DVB 317.

The final verdict

Now you should have a pretty good picture of what each of these DVD players are offering but which is the best one suited for you. The last time we had this test the Mitashi DHD 911 was the best, but this time the overall winner was the Moserbaer MBI 6988G as it struck a good balance between features and performance, but it misses just one important factor and that is the HDMI out, which could be overlooked especially with a price tag of Rs. 2,350, but we wouldn't really suggest you go for the 2.1 speaker system that Moserbaer sent with this player though even if it cost Rs. 2,500.

If you are looking for performance at its finest then we suggest you go for the Samsung DVD-H1080 as even though it is small and compact it packs quite a punch. But if you are going to buy this player you really need to accept the shape it comes in as well as the price of Rs. 5,900.

The value for money award also goes to the Moserbaer MBI 6988G as this one provides the goods along with the price too.

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